Each product is used by different systems. The script recommender uses Scripts, Cast, Movie Popularity, and Movie Trends to generate automatic recommendations for scripts worth submitting to production. Movie Trends is used by the marketing BI tool to make decisions related to investments in movie promotion and by the content recommender to generate subject suggestions for upcoming movies. The cost statement is used for financial analysis by the financial analysis system and by ERP to keep track of costs incurred.

## *5.2 What is a data product?*

We have used the term *data product* many times so far but haven't provided its definition. Referring to the generic meaning of a product in general, "an effect of a conscious action," it is relatively easy to determine what is *not* a data product. Data that was created as a side effect of another activity is not a data product. If an employee created an Excel file that is freely available, it is not a data product, for the following reasons:

- It was not created with the intention of creating a data product, i.e., no conscious effort was made to prepare it to be a data product.
- It does not address clearly defined user needs.

### *5.2.1 Data product definition*

We define *data product* as follows:

> A data product is an autonomous, read-optimized, standardized data unit containing at least one dataset (domain dataset), created for satisfying user needs.

Figure 5.5 depicts this idea. In the figure, we see that a data product is an autonomous entity that makes its data available through output ports, from which it can be used by other transaction systems, data products, or end users.